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ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

CV, Interviews and Internships: Get Your First Real Opportunity

Turn a thin CV into a credible application and interview well with little experience

MONEY & CAREER

Money & Career

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

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Why this pack exists

Freshers often believe they have nothing to put on a CV. This pack shows how to convert coursework, volunteering and side projects into evidence of skill, structure a one-page CV, prepare for common interview questions and approach internships without waiting for third year.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Build a one-page CV with clear, evidence-based bullet points.
- Convert coursework and activities into demonstrable skills.
- Prepare answers for common interview questions using a structured method.
- Find and approach internship opportunities professionally.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

A CV that survives screening

A recruiter skims for relevance. Make the first screen easy.

- One page, clean layout, consistent formatting, no photograph unless requested.
- Order: contact, education, skills, experience and projects, leadership, references.
- Use action verbs and quantify where possible: 'organised five tutorials for 30 students'.
- Tailor the top third of the CV to the opportunity.
- Remove secondary-school details once you have university results.
- Check spelling of names, dates and contact details.

> **No experience is still experience**
> Course projects, volunteering, tutoring, a small business and committee roles all demonstrate reliability and skill. Describe what you did and the result.

Interview preparation

Preparation is visible. Practise in full sentences, not in your head.

- Prepare a two-minute introduction covering who you are, what you study and what you want.
- Use the situation-action-result structure for behavioural questions.
- Prepare examples for teamwork, conflict, failure and initiative.
- Research the organisation enough to ask one intelligent question.
- Prepare your own questions about the role and expectations.
- Dress appropriately, arrive early and switch off your phone.

Finding internships and attachments

Start earlier than the deadline and use more than one channel.

- Departmental industrial training coordinators and notice boards.
- Faculty and alumni networks; a warm introduction beats a cold email.
- Small firms and startups, which are often more accessible than large companies.
- Professional associations and student chapters.
- A short email stating what you study, what you can do and what you are asking for.
- Follow up once after a week; persistence done politely is not harassment.

A CV is evidence, not a biography

A recruiter spends under a minute on a first read. That means the top third of the page decides whether the rest is read. Put your name, contact details, degree and a two-line summary of what you offer at the top, and leave out the primary school you attended.

Write in outcomes rather than duties. "Organised a departmental career event attended by 120 students" is evidence; "helped with events" is not. Where numbers exist, use them. Where they do not, describe what changed because of you.

One page is enough for a student. Use a clean font, consistent dates, and reverse chronological order. Check for spelling and consistency - one error in a contact detail can end the application before the content is read.

Interviews: structure and the STAR method